Danny Boy

Frederic Weatherly, 1913

Key: **C major** Time: **4/4** Tempo: **66 bpm** Picked: **One string a beat**

Picking to sing along to: the pattern is the accompaniment, the tune is your voice's job.

The pattern

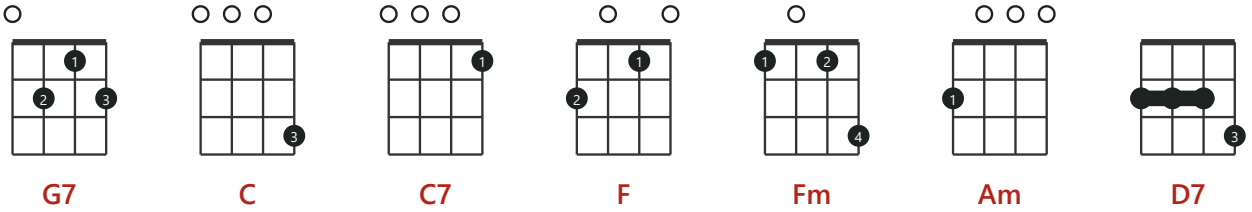
One string a beat `g C E A`

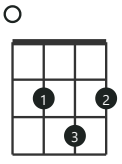
Thumb, index, middle, ring: one string a beat, from the top string down. The way in: just hold the chord and keep time.

Count	1	&	2	&	3	&	4	&
Finger	p	·	i	·	m	·	a	·
String	g	·	C	·	E	·	A	·

Fingers: p thumb · i index · m middle · a ring. + means picked together; · is a rest. Hold the whole chord shape and pick from it: every fret number in the tab is already under a finger.

The chords





The song

VERSE 1

```
  G7              C                   C7              F
A|------------2---|-----------------3-----|------------1---|------------0---|
E|--------1-------|------------0----------|--------0-------|--------1-------|
C|----2-----------|------0----------------|----0-----------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|0----------------------|0---------------|2---------------|
  Oh Danny         boy, the pipes, the     pipes are        calling

  Fm              C               Am              D7              G7
A|------------3---|------------3---|------------0---|------------3---|------------2---|
E|--------1-------|--------0-------|--------0-------|--------2-------|--------1-------|
C|----0-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|----2-----------|----2-----------|
G|1---------------|0---------------|2---------------|2---------------|0---------------|
  From glen to     glen, and       down the        mountain        side.
```

```
  G7              C               C7              F
A|------------2---|------------3---|------------1---|------------0---|
E|--------1-------|--------0-------|--------0-------|--------1-------|
C|----2-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|0---------------|0---------------|2---------------|
  The summer's     gone, and       all the roses    falling,

  C               Am              G7              F               C
A|------------3---|------------0---|------------2---|------------0---|------------3---|
E|--------0-------|--------0-------|--------1-------|--------1-------|--------0-------|
C|----0-----------|----0-----------|----2-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|2---------------|0---------------|2---------------|0---------------|
  It's you, it's   you must        go and          I must          bide.

  G               F               C               F
A|------------2---|------------0---|------------3---|------------0---|
E|--------3-------|--------1-------|--------0-------|--------1-------|
C|----2-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|2---------------|0---------------|2---------------|
  But come ye      back when       summer's in the  meadow,

  G               C               Am              D7              G
A|------------2---|------------3---|------------0---|------------3---|------------2---|
E|--------3-------|--------0-------|--------0-------|--------2-------|--------3-------|
C|----2-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|----2-----------|----2-----------|
G|0---------------|0---------------|2---------------|2---------------|0---------------|
  Or when the      valley's        hushed and       white with      snow,

  C               C7              F               Fm
A|------------3---|------------1---|------------0---|------------3---|
E|--------0-------|--------0-------|--------1-------|--------1-------|
C|----0-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|0---------------|2---------------|1---------------|
  It's I'll be     here in         sunshine or in   shadow,

  C               Am              F               G7              C
A|------------3---|------------0---|------------0---|------------2---|------------3---|
E|--------0-------|--------0-------|--------1-------|--------1-------|--------0-------|
C|----0-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|----2-----------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|2---------------|2---------------|0---------------|0---------------|
  Oh Danny         boy, oh         Danny            boy, I love you  so!
```

VERSE 2

```
  G7              C               C7                      F
A|------------2---|------------3---|--------------------1-----|------------0---|
E|--------1-------|--------0-------|------------0-----------|--------1-------|
C|----2-----------|----0-----------|------0-----------------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|0---------------|0-----------------------|2---------------|
  But when ye      come, and       all the flowers are      dying,

  Fm              C               Am              D7              G7
A|------------3---|------------3---|------------0---|------------3---|------------2---|
E|--------1-------|--------0-------|--------0-------|--------2-------|--------1-------|
C|----0-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|----2-----------|----2-----------|
G|1---------------|0---------------|2---------------|2---------------|0---------------|
  If I am          dead, as        dead I           well may        be,
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```
  G7              C               C7                      F
A|------------2---|------------3---|------------------1-----|------------0---|
E|--------1-------|--------0-------|------------0-----------|--------1-------|
C|----2-----------|----0-----------|------0-----------------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|0---------------|0-----------------------|2---------------|
  Ye'll come and   find the         place where I am        lying,

  C               Am              G7              F               C
A|------------3---|------------0---|------------2---|------------0---|------------3---|
E|--------0-------|--------0-------|--------1-------|--------1-------|--------0-------|
C|----0-----------|----0-----------|----2-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|2---------------|0---------------|2---------------|0---------------|
  And kneel and    say an           Ave             there for       me.

  G               F               C                       F
A|------------2---|------------0---|------------------3-----|------------0---|
E|--------3-------|--------1-------|------------0-----------|--------1-------|
C|----2-----------|----0-----------|------0-----------------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|2---------------|0-----------------------|2---------------|
  And I shall      hear, though     soft you tread a        bove me,

  G               C               Am              D7              G
A|------------2---|------------3---|------------0---|------------3---|------------2---|
E|--------3-------|--------0-------|--------0-------|--------2-------|--------3-------|
C|----2-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|----2-----------|----2-----------|
G|0---------------|0---------------|2---------------|2---------------|0---------------|
  And all my       grave will      warmer,         sweeter         be,

  C               C7              F                       Fm
A|------------3---|------------1---|------------------0-----|------------3---|
E|--------0-------|--------0-------|------------1-----------|--------1-------|
C|----0-----------|----0-----------|------0-----------------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|0---------------|2-----------------------|1---------------|
  For you will     bend and        tell me that you        love me,

  C               Am              F               G7              C
A|------------3---|------------0---|------------0---|------------2---|------------3---|
E|--------0-------|--------0-------|--------1-------|--------1-------|--------0-------|
C|----0-----------|----0-----------|----0-----------|----2-----------|----0-----------|
G|0---------------|2---------------|2---------------|0---------------|0---------------|
  And I shall      sleep in        peace until you  come to         me!
```

How to learn it

1. Hold one chord and play the pattern over and over, slowly, until your picking hand does it on its own.
2. Change chords on beat 1: the new shape has to be down by the time your thumb picks.
3. Then the song, slowly (Pick → Play, with the practice speed turned down), up to speed over a few days.
4. Then sing over it. If the words throw your fingers, go back to an easier pattern for a while.

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